

**Ours** Pennsylvania rejected 372,000 mail-in ballot **Some** conservative websites inaccurately reported that 372,000 mail-in ballots were rejected in Pennsylvania, conflating applications for ballots with actual ballots. "Pennsylvania rejected 372,000 mail-in ballots, leaving many voters confused: report," stated an Oct. 18 **headline** on The Geller Report. This post was flagged as part of Facebook's efforts to combat false news and misinformation on its News Feed. (Read more about our partnership with Facebook.) The attacks come during an election season when President Donald Trump has repeatedly tried to sow doubt about voting by mail, which has increased in many states amid COVID-19. The Geller Report and another outlet, The Blaze, misconstrued information from an Oct. 16 ProPublica/Philadelphia Inquirer story. Charlie Kirk, Turning Point USA founder, also tweeted the misinformation, which led to his account being locked for violating Twitter rules. ProPublica and the Inquirer reported that Pennsylvania rejected 372,000 requests for mail-in ballots, not actual ballots. (The Blaze later added an update making that distinction clear.) "More than 90% of those applications, or about 336,000, were denied as duplicates, primarily because people who had requested mail-in ballots for the state's June 2 primary did not realize that they had checked a box to be sent ballots for the general election, too," ProPublica/Inquirer stated. (The Philadelphia Inquirer is a PolitiFact partner.) Featured Fact-check Instagram posts stated on October 25, 2022 in an Instagram post The documentary 2,000 Mules proves Democrats cheated on the 2020 elections. By Jon Greenberg • October 28, 2022 As of the morning of Oct. 19, almost one-third of the state's 9 million had requested ballots. If a voter didn't sign the envelope, the envelope is returned to the voter with instructions about how to remedy it, said Amie Downs, a spokesperson for the Allegheny County elections office. But no ballots have been opened yet or rejected since they don't begin to process them until after 7 a.m. Election Day. Election officials have predicted that many mail ballots will be rejected because of the requirement that states return their ballot inside of a secrecy envelope. The number of rejected ballots could make a difference in the state that Trump won by about 44,000 votes, or less than 1%, in 2016.

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